to Eng[d]. These steamers do not now come direct, if they did they would accomplish the distance in sixteen days. — I am going on very well with the Prince and I hope making myself useful to him. I do not get my pay very regularly but I have no doubt I shall get it in the end, and then I hope to make something from the villages.

If this reaches England before William Cormick leaves I wish you would send to him or write and give him a message from me about a pair of pistols I asked him to bring out for me. I made a mistake about the size of the balls they ought to be thirty five (35) or thirty eight (38) to the lb, I ordered them larger, and the barrels should be under and over thus 8, not horizontal. — Pistols in this country are necessary particularly for me, going about so much alone as I do. There is a French agent at Tehran endeavouring to establish Jesuit missionaries in Persia: these gentry have been three times turned out of the country and I sincerely hope M. de Sartige will not be able to bring them back again. They are a bad set — I never knew but one decent man amongst them.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO MRS. HENRY BURGESS]* *Tabreez, November 7, 1844*

I received yours of the 26th Augt on the 12th Octr. The reason why letters are so long on the road is because the packets for Persia are frequently detained some days at Const[le] to enable Sir Stratford Canning to prepare his dispatches for Erzeroom and Tehran, for you must know that the commission to decide the disputes between Persia and Turkey are still at Erzeroom, and the points in dispute seem just as likely to be settled as they were a year and a half ago, when this commission first began to sit. The question now to be settled is how to keep in order the frontier tribes. Now as these tribes from Mount Ararat down to the Persian gulph are all Koords and Arabs a set of men who think it an almost unheard of tyranny not to allow them to settle their own quarrels amongst themselves, you may suppose that to put these men in order must be a work of some difficulty if not impossible. Add to which the Turkish govt have scarcely any power over these tribes, the chiefs are almost independent. The Persians manage better. They keep these people in better order altho it is done in an infamous way; they set one chief intriguing against another, perhaps even give orders appointing two rival chiefs governors of the same district, and when, after spending half their fortunes in presents and bribes, they turn out their followers to fight it out like good fellows, they fine both for not keeping the peace, and perhaps appoint a third man to the government. This is infamous enough no doubt, but then the govt keep them in subjection and are quite able to prevent their making incursions over the frontier.

* Unless otherwise noted, all of the following letters are from Edward to his mother.

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